COMMUNITY TOURNAMENT · WINTER 2026

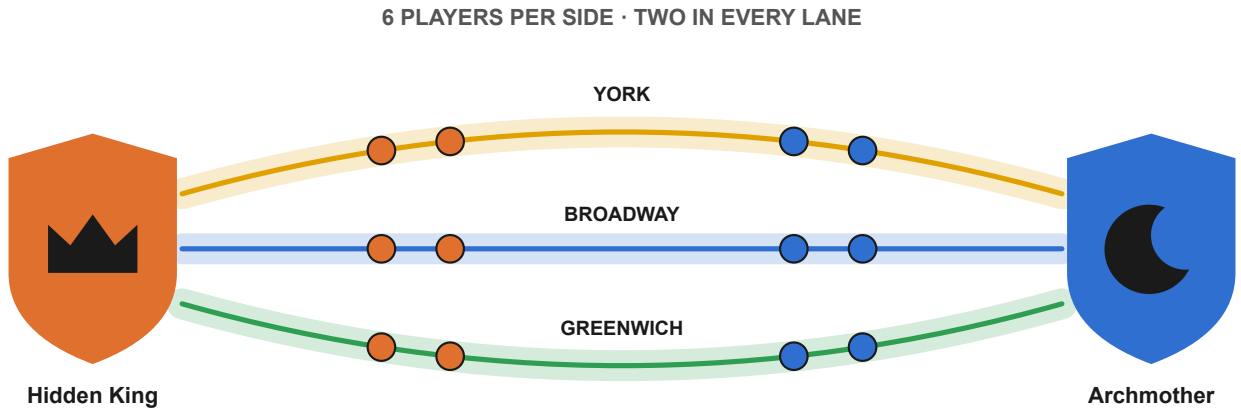
Winter Deadlock Tournament

Official Rulebook

6v6 · 4 teams · Double elimination · Best of 3 · 3-ban draft

Organizers: Henry · Stephan · Miles (If Henry or Stephan are ever fighting at the same time)

As of Nov 3, 2026



Lane map · Hidden King and Archmother, three lanes

Welcome to the Winter Deadlock Tournament

Four teams of six will battle through a double-elimination bracket, drafting heroes with a 3-ban format before every game.

This rulebook keeps things fair and clear. Above all, though, this is a friendly community event: play hard, play fair, and have fun.

If something comes up that this rulebook doesn't cover, the organizers make the call. Questions? Ask an organizer any time.

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1 Format at a glance

Everything you need to know in thirty seconds.

Item	At a glance	Details
TEAMS	**4 × 6**	24 players, plus subs
MATCHES	**6v6**	Custom Match, standard map, 2-2-2 lanes
SERIES	**Best of 3**	First team to win two games
BRACKET	**Double elim**	Straight Bo3 grand final
DRAFT	**3 + 6**	Bans and picks per team, bans revealed together
COIN FLIPS	**2 per game**	Sides, first pick
PRIZE	**Discord role**	Bragging rights for the champions

Your organizers: Henry, Stephan, Miles

2 Teams and rosters

Six players and a roster that locks once the bracket starts.

2.1 Roster size

Each team fields 6 players, two per lane (York, Broadway and Greenwich): the same 2-2-2 split as matchmaking.

2.2 Registration

Teams are preassigned. When you're ready to register, tell an organizer your team name.

2.3 Substitutes

Subs may come from outside the 24-player cap. Each sub registers with an organizer and backs up one team only. Full substitute rules are still being finalized and will be announced.

2.4 Roster lock

Rosters lock when the bracket begins. After that, only organizer-approved subs can join a team.

2.5 Lane spots

Which pair plays which lane is decided fresh after every draft (see 4.5).

3 Bracket and series

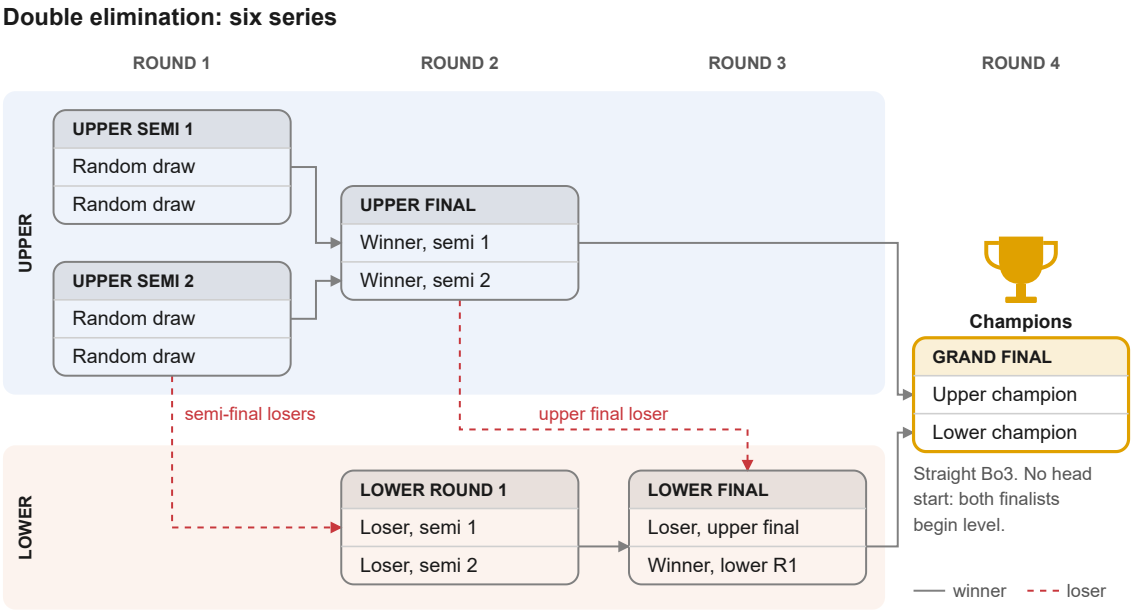
Every team gets a second chance. Lose twice and your run is over.

3.1 Bracket draw

There is no seeding. After registration closes, an organizer randomly draws the bracket order and announces it.

3.2 Series

Every bracket match is a best of 3: the first team to win two games takes the series.



Bracket · six series, upper and lower, into a straight Bo3 grand final

3.3 Double elimination

Lose a series and you drop to the lower bracket; lose a second and you're out. That's six series and 12 to 18 games in total.

3.4 Grand final

A single, straight best of 3. The upper-bracket team gets no head start, so both finalists begin level.

3.5 If fewer teams enter

With three teams, everyone plays a round robin of Bo3s and the top two meet in a Bo3 final. With two teams, it's a single Bo5.

4 The draft

Every game opens with a coin flip for sides. Both teams then ban 3 heroes and reveal them at the same time, and a second coin flip decides who picks first. Each team finishes with 3 bans and 6 picks.

4.1 Coin flips

Before each game the organizer makes two fresh coin flips so both teams see the result.

Flip	Decides	What happens
First Coin flip	**Sides**	Decides who plays **Hidden King** and who plays **Archmother**. Flips are fresh every game, so you may land on the same side twice.
Second Coin flip	**First pick**	Made after both teams reveal their bans. The winner takes the **first pick**. The other team gets the first triple pick and the **last pick**.

4.2 Draft order

Bans come before the pick flip, so neither team knows who picks first when it bans. The teams then pick 12 heroes over six turns: the coin flip 2 winner picks 1, the other team 3, the winner 3, the other team 2, the winner 2, and the other team 1. Appendix A lists every turn.

WINTER DEADLOCK TOURNAMENT · DRAFT ORDER

Team A won the pick flip, so Team A picks first

Example draft: a sides flip, 6 bans revealed together, a first-pick flip, then 12 picks over six turns.

TEAM A — Plays Hidden King — WON COIN FLIP 2 — Picks first

COIN FLIP 2: A — Team A wins

LOST COIN FLIP 2 — Picks second — **TEAM B** — Plays Archmother

BANS · 3 PER TEAM — Revealed at the same time

Chosen before coin flip 2, so neither team knows who picks first

(a) Baba, Solomon, Seven

(a) Paradox, Mina, Violet

TURN 1 · 1 hero · first pick — (b)

Haze (c) — Player 1 (d) — FIRST PICK (e) — 1 — T1

TURN 2 · 3 heroes · first triple pick — (b)

2 (e) — Lash (c) — Player 1 (d)

3 — Kelvin — Player 2

4 — Pocket — Player 3

TURN 3 · 3 heroes

5 — Abrams — Player 2

6 — Infernus — Player 3

7 — Dynamo — Player 4

TURN 4 · 2 heroes

8 — Grey Talon — Player 4

9 — Yamato — Player 5

TURN 5 · 2 heroes

10 — Lady Geist — Player 5

11 — Wraith — Player 6

TURN 6 · 1 hero · last pick

12 — Mirage — Player 6

T1 → T2 → T3 → T4 → T5 → T6

PHASES, IN ORDER

1. **Coin flip 1** — Sides. Team A gets Hidden King, Team B gets Archmother.
2. **Bans** — Each team chooses 3 heroes in secret, with no timer.
3. **Ban reveal** — Both teams' bans appear at the same time.
4. **Coin flip 2** — First pick. Team A wins and picks first.
5. **Picks** — 12 heroes, six turns. No timer: each team says when it's done.
6. **Lane reveal** — Right after pick 12, the organizer reveals both lane sheets together.

PICK ORDER, TURN BY TURN, WITH HEROES LOCKED AFTER EACH TURN

Turn 1 · A	Turn 2 · B	Turn 3 · A	Turn 4 · B	Turn 5 · A	Turn 6 · B
1	2 3 4	5 6 7	8 9	10 11	12
A1 · B0	A1 · B3	A4 · B3	A4 · B5	A6 · B5	A6 · B6

(a) Bans, hidden until the reveal **(b)** One turn: the team locks these heroes together **(c)** Hero **(d)** Player **(e)** Pick number, 1 to 12

T1 to T6 and the arrows show who picks next. Example draft: heroes and player labels are placeholders, and either team can win either flip.

Example draft board. Team A won coin flip 2, so it picks first.

4.3 Turns and bans

A pick turn has no time limit: it ends when the team says it's done. Teams choose their bans together and tell the organizer, who reveals both teams' bans at the same moment. Bans have no time limit, so teams can take as long as they need. If both teams ban the same hero, both bans stand and neither team bans again.

4.4 Hero check

A hero can be on only one team per game. Custom Match lobbies don't enforce the draft, so the organizer checks every hero against the draft sheet before the game starts.

4.5 Lane reveal

Right after pick 12:

1. Teams talk separately for 2 minutes.
2. Each team tells the organizer which pair takes York, Broadway and Greenwich.
3. The organizer reveals both lane sheets at the same moment.
4. The lobby host sets lane assignments to match.
5. Pairs start in their revealed lane. Once the game starts, anyone can swap.

5 Communication

Tell an organizer about anything team-specific. Organizers announce everything public: registration opening, the bracket draw and results.

6 Match day

Your organizers are Henry, Miles, and Stephan. If one organizer is playing in a series, the other runs it.

6.1 Organizer checklist

The organizer runs the same checklist before and after every game:

- ☐ 01 Organizer and both teams are present
- ☐ 02 Both coin flips (sides, first pick) made
- ☐ 03 Draft logged: 6 bans, 12 picks
- ☐ 04 Lanes revealed
- ☐ 05 Host creates the 6v6 Custom Match: right region, bots off (unless a short-handed team requested one, see 6.4), lanes set, organizer in a spectator slot
- ☐ 06 Organizer checks every hero against the draft, then the game starts
- ☐ 07 After the game: scoreboard screenshot; both teams confirm the result to the organizer, who announces it

6.2 Pauses

Each team may pause for up to 5 minutes per game, for disconnects or technical problems.

6.3 Remakes

If a player disconnects or the wrong hero loads in the first 2 minutes, the game restarts with the same draft and lanes.

6.4 Short-handed teams

A team missing a player at start time can play 5v6 or take the forfeit. They may also request a bot player.

6.5 Patches
Games are played on the live patch. A hero released mid-event stays banned until the next round.

6.6 Exploits
No deliberate bug abuse. The organizer decides what counts.

6.7 No-shows
Teams get 15 minutes of grace. After that, the game is forfeited.

7 Sportsmanship and rulings

7.1 Good games
It's a friendly tournament: respect opponents, teammates and organizers. Good will goes a long way.

7.2 Organizer rulings
The organizer's call is final, including on anything this rulebook doesn't cover. Appeals can only be made if both teams agree that a ruling is unfair, in which case other Organizers are consulted.

7.3 Questions
Not sure about a rule? Ask an organizer before your match. They're happy to help.

A Draft order quick reference

Keep this page handy during the draft. The pick-flip winner won coin flip 2.

Step	Who	Action	Details
1	Organizer	**COIN FLIP**	Sides (coin flip 1)
2	Both teams	**BAN**	3 bans each, revealed at the same time
3	Organizer	**COIN FLIP**	First pick (coin flip 2)
4	Pick-flip winner	**PICK**	Pick 1
5	Pick-flip loser	**PICK**	Picks 2, 3 and 4
6	Pick-flip winner	**PICK**	Picks 5, 6 and 7
7	Pick-flip loser	**PICK**	Picks 8 and 9
8	Pick-flip winner	**PICK**	Picks 10 and 11
9	Pick-flip loser	**PICK**	Pick 12

Good luck, have fun!

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